

LYMM COUNSELLING LTD

INTRODUCTION

Your privacy is very important to me and you can be confident that your personal information will be kept safe and secure and will only be used for the purpose it was given to me. I adhere to current data protection legislation, including the General Data Protection Regulation (EU/2016/679) (the GDPR), the Data Protection Act 2018 and the Privacy and Electronic Communications (EC Directive) Regulations 2003.

This privacy notice tells you what I will do with your personal information from initial point of contact through to after your therapy has ended, including:

- Why I am able to process your information and what purpose I am processing it for
- Whether you have to provide it to me
- How long I store it for
- Whether there are other recipients of your personal information
- Your data protection rights.

I am happy to chat through any questions you might have about my data protection policy and you can contact me via phone: 07974 734219 or by email: admin@lymmcounselling.org.uk

‘Data controller’ is the term used to describe the person/ organisation that collects and stores and has responsibility for people’s personal data. In this instance, the data controller is me.

I am registered with the Information Commissioner’s Office registration number ZA850694. Lymm Counselling Ltd registered company number 12913378.

My postal address is: 80 Chaise Meadow, Lymm, Cheshire, WA13 9UP. My phone number is: 07974 734219 . My email address is: admin@lymmcounselling.org.uk

My lawful basis for holding and using your personal information

The GDPR states that I must have a lawful basis for processing your personal data. There are different lawful bases depending on the stage at which I am processing your data. I have explained these below:

If you have had therapy with me and it has now ended, I will use legitimate interest as my lawful basis for holding and using your personal information.

If you are currently having therapy or if you are in contact with me to consider therapy, I will process your personal data where it is necessary for the performance of our contract.

The GDPR also makes sure that I look after any sensitive personal information that you may disclose to me appropriately. This type of information is called 'special category personal information'. The lawful basis for me processing any special categories of personal information is that it is for provision of health treatment (in this case counselling) and necessary for a contract with a health professional (in this case, a contract between me and you).

How I use your information

Initial contact

When you contact me with an enquiry about my counselling services I will collect information to help me satisfy your enquiry. This will include your name, telephone number, email address and briefly why you wish to enter into a counselling relationship. Alternatively, your GP or other health professional may send me your details when making a referral or a parent or trusted individual may give me your details when making an enquiry on your behalf.

If you decide not to proceed I will ensure all your personal data is deleted within one month. If you would like me to delete this information sooner, just let me know.

While you are accessing counselling

Rest assured that everything you discuss with me is confidential. That confidentiality will only be broken if I have concerns that you may hurt or harm yourself or others. I will always try to speak to you about this first, unless there are safeguarding issues to prevent this.

I will keep a record of your personal details to help the counselling services run smoothly. Hard copies of data are stored in a locked filing cabinet and are not shared with any third party. Electronic data will also be stored which will be password protected.

I will keep written notes of each session, these are kept on my computer which is password protected.

For security reasons I do not retain text messages for more than 6 months. If there is relevant information contained in a text message, I will transfer this to your notes which are kept on my computer. Likewise, any email correspondence will be deleted after 6 months if it is not important. If necessary I will transfer any information onto your notes on my computer.

After counselling has ended

Once counselling has ended, your records will be kept for 3 years from the end of our contract with each other and then securely destroyed. If you want me to delete your information sooner than this, please tell me.

Third party recipients of personal data

I sometimes share personal data with third parties, for example, where I have contracted with a supplier to carry out specific tasks. In such cases I have carefully selected which partners I work with. I take great care to ensure that I have a contract with the third party that states what they are allowed to do with the data I share with them. I ensure that they do not use your information in any way other than the task for which they have been contracted.